

BALAAJEE V.R.

Senior UI/UX Design Manager

- Immediate Availability
- Open to India / Global Relocation

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Chennai / Bengaluru, India

LinkedIn Profile ↗

18+ Years	50+	100%	25+	8+	10M+
in Product Design	Designers Mentored	Team Retention	Products Shipped	Industry Domains	Users Impacted

Senior UI/UX Design Manager

Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

IBM India Software Labs

Agentic AI UX | Human-in-the-Loop | Design System Governance | Org Restructuring

- Spearheaded the UX transformation of enterprise B2B platforms by integrating generative AI and agentic workflows (IBM watsonx), cutting complex task completion from **14.2 hours to 3.6 hours**.
- Restructured and scaled a multidisciplinary organization of **14+ UI/UX designers** into an agile **UX-as-a-Service model**, establishing career ladders, advancing 2 designers into lead tracks, and maintaining **100% retention**.
- Directed the UX architecture for AI confidence thresholds and automated security remediation workflows, cutting threat triage from **4.1 hours to 43 minutes** across 140,000+ enterprise tasks.
- Embedded AI tools into day-to-day DesignOps — upskilling the team, leading cross-functional AI-UX workshops, and driving **IBM Carbon Design System** adoption across US and European squads to accelerate design-to-dev handoff.

UI/UX Product Design Manager

Jul 2021 – Aug 2024

Zebra Technologies

Enterprise Mobility & IoT | Lean UX & PI Planning | Multi-Device Design Systems | UX & Content Team Scaling

- Directed end-to-end UX across B2B mobile hardware and cloud consoles (**38,000+ rugged Android endpoints**), delivering gloved-touch workflows that cut scanner pairing failures by **84%** and support tickets by **33%**.
- Shaped multi-year product roadmaps with global enterprise accounts and sales leadership, synthesizing field research and competitive insights to shift the org from reactive feature delivery to strategic innovation.
- Championed **Lean UX** and quarterly **Agile/PI planning** workshops across global engineering squads, resolving technical constraints early and standardizing multi-device design systems to cut UI rework.
- Built and led a multidisciplinary team of **UI/UX and Content Designers** from the ground up — owning end-to-end hiring loops, global capacity allocation, mentoring, and career progression.

UI/UX Senior Specialist

Oct 2020 – Jul 2021

ZF Wabco

Commercial Vehicle HMI | Fleet Telematics | Driver Safety Ergonomics | Usability & Heatmap Research

- Spearheaded UX strategy for commercial vehicle digital cockpits, infotainment, and fleet tracking platforms in collaboration with German engineering HQ.
- Cut average driver glance duration from **2.8s to 0.94s** (below the 1.2s safety threshold) by architecting a 3-tier alert hierarchy and high-contrast day/night cockpit UI standards.
- Led cross-functional alignment across product and engineering, leveraging **heatmap analytics**, contextual driver research, and simulator testing to reduce critical navigation errors by **18%** across **80,000+ vehicles**.

UI/UX Designer

Jul 2019 – Sep 2020

Ericsson Global

5G CPQ Platform | Ericsson Design System | UX Strategy Workshops | Information Architecture

- Replaced a fragmented 14-tab legacy Excel pricing workflow with a unified, keyboard-first enterprise **5G CPQ platform** — cutting quote turnaround from **6 days to 42 minutes** and achieving **94% adoption**.
- Partnered with Swedish and global stakeholders to facilitate cross-functional UX workshops, executing market analysis and generative user research to translate complex technical constraints into seamless information architecture.
- Architected and maintained the **Ericsson Design System**, standardizing reusable UI components and high-density data visualization patterns to enforce brand consistency and streamline development cycles.

Lead UI/UX Designer

Sep 2017 – Jul 2019

NP Compete Technologies

Client UX Roadmaps | Stakeholder Workshops | UI Pattern Libraries | Design Team Leadership

- Led customer requirement-gathering sessions as primary UX liaison, translating complex business needs into strategic, actionable product design roadmaps.
- Facilitated stakeholder UX workshops and rigorous market research to establish foundational style guides, reusable UI pattern libraries, and robust information architecture.
- Directed end-to-end product design cycles — managing sprint planning, resource allocation, and a team of UI/UX designers to deliver high-fidelity interactive prototypes on schedule.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Freelance UI/UX Designer

May 2015 – Aug 2017

Designed end-to-end mobile applications, responsive web platforms, interactive wireframes, and usability flows for international startup and SMB clients.

Creative Head

May 2010 – Apr 2015

Titi Technologies

Led a multidisciplinary creative team across digital product UI, brand identity systems, and interactive mobile application experiences from concept to App Store launch.

Senior Software Engineer

Jan 2006 – Apr 2010

Infosys Technologies

Developed, customized, and tested enterprise banking software modules for Finacle Universal Banking, building a strong technical foundation in front-end engineering and enterprise workflows.



PEOPLE & ORG MANAGEMENT

Hiring & Scaling: End-to-end interview loops, portfolio evaluations & onboarding.

Performance & Growth: Career ladders, promotions, performance turnaround & 1:1 coaching.

DesignOps & Delivery: UX-as-a-Service capacity planning, PI planning & design critiques.

Global Collaboration: Direct alignment across US, German, Swedish & Indian hubs.

EXPERTISE

Strategy: Product Vision, Service Blueprints, Multi-Brand Design Systems.

Research: Contextual Inquiry, Simulator & Lab Usability Testing, Journey Mapping, Heuristic Audits.

Execution: Information Architecture, Complex B2B Workflows, Engineering Handoff.

INDUSTRY DOMAINS

- Enterprise AI & SaaS
- Industrial IoT & Mobility
- Automotive & Telematics
- 5G Telecom & CPQ
- Healthcare Systems
- Core Banking & FinTech

TOOLS & GOVERNANCE

AI Tools: Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, IBM watsonx, Google Stitch, NotebookLM, Google AI Studio, Gemini.

Design: Figma, Miro, Mural, Adobe Creative Cloud.

Operations: Jira, Monday.com, Confluence, Dual-Track Agile.

Research: UserTesting, Hotjar, Google Analytics.

Governance: Enterprise Accessibility, Design System Governance, AI Human-Oversight, Data Privacy.

AWARDS

Ericsson: Spot Award for UX innovation culture & 1st Place in Global Hack-fest Contest.

Infosys: 3rd Place Winner & Best Project Nominee, Telstra Annual Excellence Awards.

Samsung: Sponsored for 10-Year US Business Visa to lead global healthcare UX research.

Consumer Impact: Designed *"Greedy Jump"* iOS game achieving 80,000+ organic downloads.

UX Challenges: 1st Place Winner in MockingBOT & UP Labs Global Design Contests.

EDUCATION

B.E. Information Technology

MS University